

Gemini Smith (she/her)

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Senior Backend Engineer

Backend engineer with 8+ years building and owning production systems in Go — ingestion pipelines, automated failover, permissions architecture, large-scale data migrations. Consistent pattern across every role: finding the problem nobody assigned, root-causing it completely, and shipping a fix that survives contact with production. Self-taught, currently extending that same systems background into AI-integrated pipelines.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Software Engineer (IC2), Supply Squad — Gametime

Remote · 09/2023 – 09/2025

- **Sole author of the Ticketmaster manifest ingestion subsystem** (~1,600 lines of Go, 91–100% ownership by git blame) — normalization, two-tier validation, event/venue matching across every MLB team and season type, S3 persistence, and delivery to Ticketmaster's API. Built alone over ~5 months; became the sole ingestion path for Ticketmaster spring training and was supported live through the MLB playoffs.
- Identified that duplicate supplier CSV uploads (some suppliers pushing every 30 seconds) were fully re-parsed every time; designed a file-hashing dedupe at the FTP ingress layer. **Pitched it at a hackathon — the idea didn't place, but it shipped to production weeks later anyway**, cutting parsing jobs ~30% and CSV lines parsed ~10% and ending the ingest backlogs that had let stale listings sell and pulled engineers into troubleshooting.
- Root-caused a data-integrity bug where listings existed in MongoDB with no matching PostgreSQL row, leaving unsellable inventory live and producing real customer refunds. Added graceful shutdown to the CSV parser (tuned to p99 latency) and extended an internal reconciliation tool to detect and repair orphaned records — **947 and 21,737 listings fixed** across two suppliers.
- Designed and shipped a regex-based fallback matcher for supplier section/row values that failed primary section-map lookup, converting a class of hard listing rejections into successful matches, with per-listing match-method observability (universal vs. regex) added to support it in production.
- 580+ commits across 15 repositories; #1 or #2 contributor on several core services.

Software Engineer (Backend) — Syndio

Remote · 11/2021 – 05/2023

- Owned the permissions/RBAC domain for a multi-product pay-equity platform (PayEQ team: \$19M ARR) serving Fortune 500 employers — designed a YAML-defined role model code-generated into both Go and Python so the two runtimes couldn't drift, and shipped per-product seat licensing and cross-org “external user” access as backwards-compatible, phased production migrations.
- Asked to stub an API surface for the frontend team; instead built mocked APIs with controllable, URL-encoded response behavior plus a test suite that doubled as the backend contract spec — **one piece of work unblocked two teams in parallel**.
- Self-initiated investigation into a company-wide ephemeral-environment outage (every engineer and QA person hitting silent failures); root-caused to NGINX response-header size limits. Fix never recurred.

DevOps Engineer, L2+ (previously Test Automation Engineer, L2) — Freshly

Remote · 08/2019 – 11/2021

- **Designed, scoped (9 self-written tickets), and built end-to-end an automated failover system** protecting the company's homepage — the sole entry point to a \$430M revenue funnel — from third-party CMS outages, automatically rerouting traffic via Istio on failure and reverting on recovery. 88.9% test coverage on the core package.
- Executed the production PostgreSQL migration (1.27B+ rows) from Heroku to GCP using Striim CDC with **zero downtime and zero post-migration fixes** — built the tooling to bucket tables into 30 parallel import jobs against a hard 16-thread platform ceiling.
- Root-caused a recurring production connection failure to an hour-long silent hang in a third-party payment API held open inside a Postgres transaction; identified the fix (gRPC deadlines) and built the diagnostic path the team used afterward.

Software Engineer — Backend / Test — Brightcove

Scottsdale, AZ · 11/2016 – 08/2019

- Held sole responsibility for test automation on Brightcove's Server Side Video and Ad Insertion product while designing and building, unprompted, a highly configurable in-house ad server on AWS Lambda/DynamoDB — variable-length ad creatives, placement control, trackable playback URLs, and support for three industry ad-response formats (VAST, SmartXML/Freewheel, Google DFP), all consolidated under a single URL driven by path and query parameters. **Adopted company-wide, including sales demos and conference booths; still running in production 6+ years after departure.**
- Backend Go engineer on the APIs driving the company's video ingest platform.

PROJECTS

Public, github.com/mxygem

- **perfapi** (Go) — Wrote the initial Go implementation and orchestration CLI (deterministic port assignment, fleet lifecycle) for an API benchmarking harness; used AI-assisted prompting to extend the same API across 13 additional languages out of curiosity.

SKILLS

Go, Python, JavaScript · Kubernetes, Docker, Istio, Terraform · GCP, AWS · PostgreSQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis · CI/CD, Datadog